

Section B Option 2: Youth subcultures

This option focuses on youth as an important period in the socialisation process when individuals are developing a sense of identity within their peer groups. It allows learners to explore different types of youth subcultures and the roles they may play in society.

Key questions	Content	Learners should:
1. How and why are youth culture and subcultures formed?	Theoretical views of the role and formation of youth culture and subcultures: • functionalism • Marxism/neo-Marxism • feminism • postmodernism Subcultures as related to: • social class • gender • ethnicity • hybridity	use illustrative examples of subcultures to explore how and why youth culture and subcultures are formed. consider issues of consensus versus conflict, social order and control in relation to theoretical views of the role and formation of youth culture and subculture.
2. Why do young people participate in deviant subcultures?	Deviant subcultures: • delinquent subcultures • criminal subcultures • spectacular youth subcultures • anti-school subcultures • gangs Patterns and trends in youth deviance related to: • social class • gender • ethnicity Explanations for young people participating in deviant subcultures: • functionalism/New Right • Marxism/neo-Marxism • interactionism • culture and identity The media and youth deviance: • deviance amplification • folk devils • moral panics	consider newer/emerging types of deviant subcultures. consider patterns and trends (within the last 30 years) of youth deviance based on the evidence presented by official statistics. consider both theoretical and identity based explanations, which could include issues of ethnic identity and gender.

Section B Option 3: Media

This option focuses on how media plays an increasingly important role as an agent of socialisation in contemporary society. It allows learners to explore a range of evidence relating to media representations and media effects.

Key questions	Content	Learners should:
1. How are different social groups represented in the media?	Evidence of representations in the media and how far these are changing in relation to: • ethnicity (majority and minority ethnic groups) • gender (masculinity and femininity) • social class (middle, working, upper, under) • age (young and old) Theoretical views of media representations: • Marxism • neo-Marxism • pluralism • feminism • postmodernism	be able to discuss representation of a range of ethnicities. For example learners could consider UK nationalities (Irish, Scottish, Welsh, English) and also newer immigrant groups as well as more established minority ethnic groups. understand explanations for these representations, and any changing representations, utilising theoretical perspectives as appropriate. consider issues of consensus versus conflict, social order and control in relation to theoretical views of media representations. use postmodernism as a critique of other theoretical views.
2. What effect do the media have on audiences?	Theoretical views of media effects: • direct • indirect • active audience The role of the media in deviance amplification and the creation of moral panics	understand a range of theories on the effects of the media on the audience, including: hypodermic syringe; two-step flow; cultural effects; uses and gratifications.